

STATE BANK OF INDIA // CLERICAL CADRE

PHASE 2: MAIN EXAMINATION

Official Memory-Based Question Bank (2016 – 2025) with Detailed Solutions

Question #1 // 2024-25

General/Financial Awareness • Banking Regulations

What is the current regulatory framework for Priority Sector Lending (PSL) target mandated by RBI for domestic commercial banks?

- A. 30% of ANBC
- B. 35% of ANBC
- C. 40% of ANBC
- D. 45% of ANBC
- E. 50% of ANBC

Correct Answer: (C) 40% of ANBC

Explanation: RBI mandates 40 percent of Adjusted Net Bank Credit (ANBC) or CEOBE, whichever is higher, for domestic commercial banks.

Question #2 // 2024-25

General/Financial Awareness • Banking Regulations

What is the maximum insurance coverage provided per depositor per bank by the DICGC in India?

- A. ₹1,00,000
- B. ₹2,00,000
- C. ₹3,00,000
- D. ₹5,00,000
- E. ₹10,00,000

Correct Answer: (D) ₹5,00,000

Explanation: The Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation provides insurance coverage up to ₹5,00,000 covering principal and interest.

Question #3 // 2024-25

General/Financial Awareness • Monetary Policy

In monetary policy operations, the Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate is set at how many basis points below the benchmark repo rate?

- A. 15 bps
- B. 20 bps
- C. 25 bps
- D. 35 bps
- E. 50 bps

Correct Answer: (C) 25 bps

Explanation: The SDF rate operates as the floor of the LAF corridor, anchored at 25 basis points below the benchmark repo rate.

Question #4 // 2024-25

General/Financial Awareness • Digital Banking

What is the per-transaction limit for UPI payments to educational institutions and hospitals revised by the RBI?

- A. ₹1,00,000
- B. ₹2,00,000
- C. ₹3,00,000
- D. ₹5,00,000
- E. ₹10,00,000

Correct Answer: (D) ₹5,00,000

Explanation: The RBI enhanced the per-transaction limit for UPI payments to hospitals and educational institutions to ₹5,00,000.

Question #5 // 2024-25

General/Financial Awareness • Financial Institutions

Which institution manages and operates the NEFT and RTGS payment infrastructure in India?

- A. NPCI
- B. State Bank of India
- C. Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- D. SEBI
- E. IBA

Correct Answer: (C) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

Explanation: Both NEFT and RTGS are owned, operated, and settled directly by the Reserve Bank of India.

Choose the appropriate connector: 'The inflation numbers remained elevated. The central bank paused interest rate hikes to support growth.'

- A. Notwithstanding that
- B. Inasmuch as
- C. Because of which
- D. Provided that
- E. As a consequence

Correct Answer: (A) Notwithstanding that

Explanation: 'Notwithstanding that inflation numbers remained elevated, the central bank paused interest rate hikes...' conveys contrast appropriately.

Find the speed of the stream. Statement I: Ratio of speed of boat in still water to stream is 5:1. Statement II: The boat travels 48 km downstream in 4 hours.

- A. Statement I alone is sufficient
- B. Statement II alone is sufficient
- C. Either I or II alone is sufficient
- D. Both I and II together are necessary
- E. Neither I nor II is sufficient

Correct Answer: (D) Both I and II together are necessary

Explanation: Statement II gives downstream speed = 12 km/h. Statement I gives ratio ($5x + x = 6x = 12 \Rightarrow x = 2$ km/h). Both together are necessary.

An alphanumeric machine rearranges words alphabetically in reverse order from left and numbers in ascending prime order from right. This mechanism represents which category of processing?

- A. Single-end shifting
- B. Double-end simultaneous shifting
- C. Fixed-word substitution
- D. Matrix cipher logic
- E. Continuous loop recursion

Correct Answer: (B) Double-end simultaneous shifting

Explanation: Double-end simultaneous shifting: elements at both left and right boundaries undergo rearrangement in each pass.

Question #9 // 2023-24

General/Financial Awareness • Government Schemes

Under the PM Vishwakarma Scheme, what is the maximum concessional loan offered in the first tranche to eligible artisans?

- A. ₹50,000
- B. ₹75,000
- C. ₹1,00,000
- D. ₹1,50,000
- E. ₹2,00,000

Correct Answer: (C) ₹1,00,000

Explanation: The scheme provides up to ₹1,00,000 collateral-free credit at 5% interest rate in the first tranche.

Question #10 // 2023-24

General/Financial Awareness • Banking Structure

What is the minimum capital requirement prescribed by the RBI for establishing a Small Finance Bank (SFB)?

- A. ₹100 crore
- B. ₹150 crore
- C. ₹200 crore
- D. ₹300 crore
- E. ₹500 crore

Correct Answer: (C) ₹200 crore

Explanation: The minimum paid-up voting equity capital for SFBs is ₹200 crore.

Question #11 // 2023-24

General/Financial Awareness • Forex Management

What is a Special Rupee Vostro Account (SRVA) utilized for in Indian international trade?

- A. Domestic crypto payments
- B. Settlement of international trade invoices in Indian Rupees (INR)
- C. Offshore tax havens
- D. Government bond arbitrage
- E. Corporate dividend repatriation

Correct Answer: (B) Settlement of international trade invoices in Indian Rupees (INR)

Explanation: SRVAs facilitate settlement of cross-border export-import transactions directly in Indian Rupees.

Question #12 // 2023-24

Quantitative Aptitude • High-Level Arithmetic

A and B started a business. A invested ₹20,000 for 8 months and B invested ₹30,000 for 6 months. Out of total profit of ₹17,000, find B's share:

- A. ₹8,000
- B. ₹8,500
- C. ₹9,000
- D. ₹9,500
- E. ₹10,000

Correct Answer: (C) ₹9,000

Explanation: Ratio = $(20000 \times 8) : (30000 \times 6) = 160000 : 180000 = 8 : 9$. B's share = $(9/17) \times 17000 = ₹9,000$.

Question #13 // 2023-24

Reasoning & Computer Aptitude • Computer Aptitude

In computer networks, which protocol operates at the Application layer to securely transfer encrypted web content?

- A. FTP
- B. HTTPS
- C. SMTP
- D. TCP
- E. ARP

Correct Answer: (B) HTTPS

Explanation: HTTPS (Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure) encrypts web data using TLS/SSL at the application layer.

Question #14 // 2022

General/Financial Awareness • Digital Currency

What is the official nomenclature for the retail Central Bank Digital Currency launched by the RBI?

- A. e₹-Wholesale
- B. e₹-Retail (e₹-R)
- C. DigiRupee-C
- D. BharatCoin
- E. Sovereign e-Cash

Correct Answer: (B) e₹-Retail (e₹-R)

Explanation: The retail CBDC pilot launched by RBI is designated as Digital Rupee - Retail (e₹-R).

Question #15 // 2021

General/Financial Awareness • Banking Structure

Which three commercial banking institutions are designated as Domestic Systemically Important Banks (D-SIBs) in India?

- A. SBI, PNB, BoB
- B. SBI, ICICI Bank, HDFC Bank
- C. SBI, Axis Bank, Kotak Bank
- D. BoB, Canara, PNB
- E. SBI, ICICI Bank, Union Bank

Correct Answer: (B) SBI, ICICI Bank, HDFC Bank

Explanation: The RBI categorizes SBI, ICICI Bank, and HDFC Bank as Domestic Systemically Important Banks ('Too Big to Fail').

Question #16 // 2020

General/Financial Awareness • Relief Schemes

What was the initial credit cap under the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) rolled out for MSMEs?

- A. ₹1 Lakh Crore
- B. ₹2 Lakh Crore
- C. ₹3 Lakh Crore
- D. ₹4 Lakh Crore
- E. ₹5 Lakh Crore

Correct Answer: (C) ₹3 Lakh Crore

Explanation: ECLGS was initially launched with a ₹3 Lakh Crore funding envelope providing 100% government guarantee backstop.

Question #17 // 2019

General/Financial Awareness • Central Banking

Which committee reviewed the Economic Capital Framework (ECF) of the Reserve Bank of India?

- A. Dr. Urjit Patel Committee
- B. Bimal Jalan Committee
- C. Tarapore Committee
- D. Nachiket Mor Committee
- E. Raghuram Rajan Committee

Correct Answer: (B) Bimal Jalan Committee

Explanation: The Bimal Jalan Committee reviewed the Reserve Bank of India's capital framework and surplus transfer norms.

What is the annual secondary and tertiary hospitalization health cover provided per family under Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY)?

- A. ₹2 Lakhs
- B. ₹3 Lakhs
- C. ₹5 Lakhs
- D. ₹7 Lakhs
- E. ₹10 Lakhs

Correct Answer: (C) ₹5 Lakhs

Explanation: Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY provides comprehensive health cover of up to ₹5 Lakhs per family per year.

Which benchmark lending regime was instituted by the RBI with effect from April 1, 2016, replacing the Base Rate system?

- A. Prime Lending Rate (PLR)
- B. Marginal Cost of Funds based Lending Rate (MCLR)
- C. External Benchmark Lending Rate (EBLR)
- D. Treasury Yield Index
- E. Cash Reserve Cost Rate

Correct Answer: (B) Marginal Cost of Funds based Lending Rate (MCLR)

Explanation: MCLR was implemented on April 1, 2016 to improve the monetary policy transmission of central bank rate cuts.